
Handling Criticism and Haters

Not internalizing the hate

4 psychology approaches · by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

Not internalizing the hate

The more visible you are, the more criticism you attract — and sometimes pure hate. The trap is internalizing these attacks as if they said something true about you.

This guide helps you tell the useful from the toxic, and protect your peace.

YOUR INTENTION

The type of comments that affect you most: _____

A hater speaks about themselves, not you

Online hate often comes from projection, frustration or anonymity: a hater reveals their own pain, not a truth about you. You must tell useful criticism (constructive, specific) from pure hate (gratuitous, degrading).

Understanding this keeps you from giving power to what doesn't deserve it.

Example

Léa collapsed at each insult; understanding a hater speaks about themselves helped her stop taking it all personally.

Sort it

A recent criticism: useful (constructive) or pure hate (gratuitous)?

It's about them

Write: 'Gratuitous hate is about them, not me.'

Takeaway — A hater reveals their pain — it's about them, not you.

'Maybe they're right'

'Maybe they're right', 'everyone hates me', 'one mean comment erases a hundred kind ones': these thoughts give negativity disproportionate weight.

Reframing them restores proportion.

Example

'If I'm hated, I must be worthless' obsessed Sami, until he saw a troll didn't represent his audience.

Spot the bias

Note a thought over-valuing a negative comment · a fairer version.

Proportion

Write: 'A troll doesn't represent my audience.'

Takeaway — One mean comment shouldn't erase a hundred kind ones.

Your worth isn't their words

Your worth isn't measured by strangers' insults. Protecting your peace of mind isn't fragility: it's common sense. You're not obliged to absorb every attack.

Detaching from haters' opinion is an act of self-respect.

Example

By deciding peace was worth more than replying to every troll, Nia regained calm.

My peace

What helps you detach from a hateful comment?

Not their words

Write: 'My worth isn't measured by strangers' words.'

Takeaway — Your worth isn't measured by strangers' insults.

Filter, moderate, don't feed

In practice: moderate and block without guilt, don't feed the trolls (don't reply to gratuitous hate), keep a folder of positive messages for hard days, and only respond to genuinely constructive criticism.

Your space, your rules: you have the right to make it healthy.

Example

By blocking trolls and keeping a 'positive folder', Karim transformed his relationship with comments.

My rules

A moderation rule to apply (block, ignore, keep the positive): _____

Don't feed

Write: 'I don't feed trolls; I respond to the constructive.'

Takeaway — Moderate, block, don't feed trolls: your space, your rules.

Key takeaways

- A hater reveals their pain — it's about them, not you.
- Tell useful criticism from pure hate.
- A troll doesn't represent your audience.
- Your worth isn't measured by strangers' words.
- Moderate and block without guilt, don't feed trolls.
- Keep a 'positive folder' for hard days.

Your turn

Sorting

Useful or pure hate?	The thought over-valuing the negative

My rules

What helps me detach	My moderation rule

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

Understand a hater speaks about themselves.

Week 2

Reframe 'maybe they're right'.

Week 3

Detach my worth from their words.

Week 4

Filter, moderate, keep the positive.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'it's about them, not me' line:

What helps me detach:

My moderation rule:

Protect your peace: gratuitous hate has nothing to teach you about you.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not therapy. A creator's life can be draining: if you feel overwhelmed, a professional (psychologist) can help. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.